JOB GETTING COURSE

Homework Portfolio

Lessons 09/09/2026 – 28/10/2026

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Group: ICT-31

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Attached files: Résumé · Cover letter · Pitch script

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How to read this portfolio

- Grey boxes quote the teacher's task; my answer follows.
- **TO DO** boxes mark the few things that only I can do personally (a quiz, a form, the video, sending files).
- Video answers are based on what the speakers actually say in the videos; vacancies were checked on Djinni on 30 October 2026.

LESSON 1 · 09/09/2026

Job Search Basics for Young Professionals

1. Video: “Job & Career Advice for Young People” (WGN News) — career tips

Task: *Watch the video and get career tips for young people.*

In the video, New York Times reporter Emma Goldberg, who writes about work and careers, gives three main tips:

1. **Think about a dream career, not one dream job.** Jobs change very quickly because of artificial intelligence and automation, so it is healthier to find your underlying passion and skills — for example storytelling, engineering or data analytics — which open many different jobs.
2. **Use the “seven stories” method.** Remember about seven moments in your life when you felt that your personal gifts were recognised, and connect them to possible jobs and careers.
3. **Breadth, not only depth.** Experts talk about *exploration* versus *exploitation*: going deep into one thing is useful, but young people benefit even more from trying many activities, even outside their comfort zone, because they may discover unexpected interests and skills.

My takeaway. My own “stories” are the moments when I built something that other people use: the campus network for 700+ users and the website that I deploy for Luxora. They point to one career — building and supporting infrastructure — rather than to a single job title.

2. BBC article: “Six essential skills employers say job seekers should have to stand out”

Task: *Read and be ready to discuss.*

The article (BBC, education editor Branwen Jeffreys) reports a five-year study by the National Foundation for Educational Research (NFER). It names six transferable skills that will count as much as qualifications. My discussion notes:

Skill	What employers in the article say	My example
Organising, planning and prioritising	Christian Townsley (North Bar): keep a “cool head”, organise and multitask.	I combine full-time study with part-time work for Luxora and my role in the Student Parliament.
Problem solving and decision-making	Maria Aderonmu learnt to think on her feet; India Chaplin: use problem-solving experience from outside work.	Choosing redundant uplinks and STP for the campus network so that one failed link does not stop the network.
Communication	Jake Readman: develop communication skills and learn to de-escalate conflict.	Explaining technical decisions and giving updates to the client at Luxora.
Collaboration	Lynn Bassett (Barbour): every department is interlinked, so working as one team is important.	KPI dashboards and reports for cross-department work in the Student Parliament.
Creative thinking	Barbour asks: “Give us an example of when something's not gone to plan and how you got it back on track.”	Finding a way to fit security features (port security, DHCP snooping, DAI) into one network design.
Information literacy (evaluating data)	India Chaplin: raw data does not “tell a story” — you must understand what it tells us.	Reading monitoring data from Grafana and Prometheus; building analytical dashboards.

For discussion. The article says that 42% of employers named a lack of soft skills or work readiness as a challenge when they hire young people. In my opinion, for IT the most important skill from the list is problem solving, because a DevOps engineer's day is mostly about finding the cause of a problem and fixing it. However, without communication even a good solution can fail, because the team and the client must understand it.

3. Vocabulary exercises “Work”

Task 1. Verbs — match the words in bold with their definitions.

#	Definition	Answer
1	to give up a job	to resign
2	to ask for a job, usually by writing a letter	to apply for
3	to be removed from a job because you have done something bad	to be dismissed
4	same as 1	to hand in your notice
5	to stop work and take a pension	to retire
6	to write in the empty spaces on a form	to fill in
7	to be given a better job in the organisation	to be promoted
8	to be questioned by people when you apply for a job	to attend an interview
9	to travel to work from home each day	to commute
10	to be dismissed for a time until more work is available	to be laid off (lay off)

Task 2. Nouns — fill in the gaps.

A computer company had a (1) **vacancy** for the position of (2) **salesman**, and decided to advertise for a new (3) **employee**. A lot of (4) **applicants** with good (5) **qualifications** and (6) **references** applied for the job, and after all the interviews had finished, the directors made a (7) **shortlist** of the best (8) **candidates**, then invited them to come back for another interview.

The person who eventually got the job was very happy. After all, he would receive an annual (9) **salary** of £25,000, with a 5% (10) **increment** twice a year, a 15% (11) **commission** for each computer he managed to sell, excellent (12) **perks** such as private health insurance and a company car, a company (13) **pension** to make sure he would be well-off when he retired, and the chance of (14) **promotion** from salesman to sales (15) **manager** if he was successful. All in all, his future (16) **prospects** looked very good.

→ *Gaps 4 and 8 can swap: applicants / candidates.*

LESSON 2 · 16/09/2026

Job hunting

1. Vocabulary

→ Learnt — see my example sentences in Appendix A (16/09).

2. Quiz “What is your tech personality?” (Codecademy)

TO DO: Take the quiz at codecademy.com/explore/sorting-quiz and add a screenshot of your result here. The result depends on your own answers, so it cannot be prepared in advance.

3. Video: “Tell Me About Yourself — an excellent answer” (English with Lucy) — my takeaways

- Talk about **work, not your personal life**. Keep your life stories for later.
- Give a **brief overview** — like the text on the back of a book: interesting, but not the whole story.
- If your experience is similar to the job, start at the beginning; if not, **start with the most relevant position**.
- A new graduate can talk about **university, part-time jobs and volunteering**, not only paid work.
- For each experience, mention **one major achievement** — hard (a new programming language) or soft (communication, solving a problem) — and be specific.
- Finish by connecting your skills to **the job you are applying for**; research the company first.

My answer to “Tell me about yourself” (Lucy's homework task):

“I'm a third-year Information Systems and Technologies student at Taras Shevchenko National University of Kyiv, and I'm starting my career in DevOps and networking. My first big project was a three-tier campus network for more than 700 users: I designed the VLANs, routing and security, and documented everything. Now I work part-time for Luxora, a company from Germany: I develop their website and I'm responsible for its deployment with Docker and Nginx on a Linux server. One of my proudest moments was delivering an ISO 27001-based security audit to a commercial client. I understand from your job post that you need someone who can support Linux and Docker infrastructure, and I'm sure that my practical experience will help me do that well.”

4. My 3–4 hard and 4 soft skills

Hard skills	Soft skills
Cisco networking: VLANs, inter-VLAN routing, STP, ACLs	Accountable by default — I support the Luxora website in production
Docker, Docker Compose, Linux administration, Nginx	Systems-minded — I designed a network with core, distribution and access layers
Python and SQL (PostgreSQL, Supabase)	Collaborative — I build reports for cross-department work in the Student Parliament
Security auditing: ISO 27001, penetration testing (VAPT)	Learning-agile — Cisco courses, Oracle and Mate Academy while studying full-time

LESSON 3 · 23/09/2026

Elevator pitch. Transferable skills

1. The type of job I'm interested in

Item	My answer
Role	Junior DevOps Engineer (second option: Junior Network Engineer)
Tasks	maintain CI/CD pipelines; build and run Docker containers; administer Linux servers and Nginx; monitor services (Prometheus, Grafana) and investigate alerts; automate routine work with Bash or Python; document the infrastructure
Type	a technical infrastructure and operations role in an IT product or service company
Market	international (remote) and local (Kyiv)
Format	part-time while I study; full-time after graduation

2. Relevant vacancies and their requirements

Three real vacancies from Djinni, published in October 2026 (checked on 30 October 2026):

Company and role	Format, English, experience	Key requirements	Nice to have
Rangein — Junior DevOps Engineer (20 Oct)	Remote, full-time; English B2; 1–2 years	Linux and command line; hands-on Docker; CI/CD (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins); one cloud (AWS, Azure or GCP); Git; Bash or Python scripting; networking, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS; basic IaC; monitoring and logging	Kubernetes, Terraform or Ansible, Prometheus and Grafana, Nginx, Helm or Argo CD
RedCore — Junior DevOps Engineer (23 Oct)	Remote, full-time; English B1; 2+ years	2+ years of Linux administration; TCP/IP, HTTP/HTTPS, DNS; Nginx proxying; Prometheus and Grafana; MongoDB, PostgreSQL, ClickHouse; CI/CD principles; Terraform and Ansible; Git; AWS or GCP; Kubernetes (EKS), Docker, Bash or Python	Cloudflare or another CDN, NATS, Redis, Jira
Kyivstar.Tech — Network Operations Engineer (16 Oct)	Hybrid (Kyiv), full-time; English B1; 2 years	TCP/IP and OSI; hands-on Cisco switches, routers and wireless; VLANs/802.1Q, STP/RSTP, EtherChannel; IPv4 subnetting, static routing, OSPF, BGP; Wi-Fi controllers; troubleshooting with ping, traceroute, SSH, packet captures	Cisco Catalyst/Nexus, VXLAN/EVPN, Zabbix or Grafana, ACL/NAT/firewalls, Python or Ansible, CCNA

What the vacancies have in common: Linux, Docker, Git, CI/CD, Bash or Python scripting, networking fundamentals (TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP) and monitoring. English B1–B2 is enough.

My match. I already have Linux, Docker, Nginx, Git, Python, networking, Cisco and basic monitoring. My gaps are commercial experience (the vacancies ask for 1–2 years), CI/CD pipelines, Terraform or Ansible, and a cloud platform (AWS, Azure or GCP). My plan is to finish the Mate Academy DevOps track and add a CI/CD pipeline to my Luxora project.

3. My pitch

→ Structure: self-introduction → key skills → achievements → problems I can solve → call to action. The same text is in the file “Pitch_script_Petro_Kravchenko”, ready for the video.

1. Self-introduction Hello! My name is Petro Kravchenko. I'm a junior DevOps and network engineer with a passion for reliable and secure infrastructure, and a third-year student of Information Systems and Technologies at Taras Shevchenko National University of Kyiv.

2. Key skills I'm proficient in Docker, Linux and Nginx, and I'm experienced in Cisco networking — VLANs, routing and network security. I'm also familiar with Python, SQL and monitoring with Grafana and Prometheus.

3. Achievements I designed a three-tier campus network for more than 700 users. Now I develop and deploy a business website for Luxora, a company from Germany: I containerised it with Docker and run it on a Linux server behind Nginx. I have also carried out an ISO 27001-based security audit and a penetration test for a commercial client.

4. Problems I can solve I specialise in building and supporting infrastructure that is fast, secure and easy to maintain — from the network to the container.

5. Call to action I look forward to demonstrating how I can add value to your team. Let's talk!

LESSON 4 · 26/09/2026

Interesting facts about résumé writing. Résumé structure

1. Video: “CV vs Resume: What's the difference?” (Resume Genius)

- Most of the time the two words mean the same thing: a document that shows your work experience, education and skills.
- In the **USA and Canada**, a *résumé* is a one- or two-page document for a job search; it focuses on your most relevant experience. A *CV* there usually means an **academic CV**: publications, conferences, teaching, dissertations — for grad school, research or medicine.
- In the **UK and most of Europe**, *CV* is used both for jobs and for academia; the word *résumé* is less common but understood.
- **For me:** for Ukrainian and European companies I can say “CV”; for an American company — “résumé”. The content is the same one-page document.

2. Article: “Interesting Facts About Resume Writing” (Timothy Lewis, LinkedIn)

Key facts from the article:

1. Recruiters spend only **6–7 seconds** on a résumé, so the name, contacts, job title and key skills must be easy to find.
2. Up to **75%** of résumés are filtered out by an Applicant Tracking System (ATS) before a person sees them.
3. **Bullet points** make a résumé easier to read.
4. A **tailored** résumé increases your chances of getting noticed by 50%.
5. **Numbers** speak louder than words: “Increased sales by 20% in 6 months”.
6. One page is ideal for most people with less than 10 years of experience.
7. **Irrelevant information** is a common mistake.
8. **Keywords** from the job posting matter, but do not “keyword stuff”.
9. **White space** is not wasted space.
10. **Education does not always come first** — unless you are a recent graduate or apply for an academic role.

For discussion. The most surprising fact for me is the 6–7 seconds. That is why I put my job title and the main keywords (Docker, Linux, Cisco) at the very top of my résumé. I do not fully agree with fact 10 for students: Google's recruiters (video of 30/09) say that students should put education first. As a student, I keep education near the top but after my projects, because my projects show more of what I can do.

3. Vacancies and requirements

→ *See the vacancy analysis in the lesson of 23/09 (three vacancies from October 2026).*

4. Résumé template and summary

My résumé has all the required sections: photo; contact information (name, phone, email, LinkedIn, city and country); summary; experience and projects; skills; education and certifications; languages. The final version is in the file “Resume_Petro_Kravchenko”.

Question	My summary
Who are you?	A junior DevOps & network engineer and a third-year Information Systems and Technologies student with a security-first mindset.
What can you offer?	Docker, Linux, Nginx, Cisco networking, Python and SQL; a 3-tier network for 700+ users; a production website deployed for a German client; an ISO 27001-based audit.
What value can you bring?	End-to-end ownership of infrastructure: I build it, secure it and keep it running, so the team can focus on the product.

5. Video 3.1.1: Esther, a jobseeker applying for an internship

→ The coursebook video (with James Caan and careers coach John Lees) is not available online, so the answers that need the video are left as lines to complete in class. Questions that do not depend on the video are answered.

Ex. 2. Three rules for writing a CV:

Ex. 3. 1, 2, 4, 5, 6 — complete after watching:

Ex. 3, question 3. *Soft skills* are personal qualities: communication, teamwork, time management, problem solving, adaptability. *Hard skills* are technical abilities that you can learn and measure: configuring Cisco routers, writing Python, using Docker, speaking a foreign language.

Ex. 3, question 7. “Getting a job is a job in itself” means that looking for a job takes as much time and effort as real work: you research companies, tailor your CV for every vacancy, write cover letters and prepare for interviews.

Ex. 4. Rule 3, gaps 1–6 — complete after watching:

Ex. 5.1. To stand out from the crowd at an interview, I would give one concrete example instead of general words: “I designed a network for 700+ users” sounds stronger than “I'm a hard-working team player”. I would also show that I know the company and ask a good question at the end.

Ex. 5.2. Positive characteristics: responsible, calm under pressure, curious. Skills: network design (Cisco), Docker and Linux, Python.

LESSON 5 · 30/09/2026

Tips for creating a killer résumé

1. Video: “Create Your Resume for Google: Tips and Advice” — my insights

- Simple and consistent format; **PDF** is preferred; contacts at the top; no references needed.
- **One page** for business and internship roles, no longer than **two pages** for engineering roles.
- For technical candidates: list **programming languages** at the top and add a **GitHub** profile.
- Students and recent graduates put **education first**, with the (expected) graduation date in *month year* format and the GPA.
- Experience is not only jobs: research, tutoring, personal and class projects, hackathons.
- Use **action words** (created, designed, debugged…) and the words of the job description.
- The Google formula: **“Accomplished [X] as measured by [Y], by doing [Z]”**.
- The most important tip: **always check for typos**.

What I changed after the video: I added the expected graduation year and the GPA, kept programming languages in the Skills section and used action verbs. Next step: create a public GitHub profile with my network and Docker projects and add the link to my résumé.

2. Text “6 Tips for Creating a Killer Resume” — exercises

Exercise 1B. Find the highlighted terms:

#	Meaning	Term
1	Immediately	right out of the gate
2	Reviewing written work and marking any errors	proofreading
3	Including all aspects of something	comprehensive
4	Submit a request	apply (for)
5	Adapted for a particular purpose	tailored (for)
6	People looking for a job	job seekers
7	Remove or delete	take off
8	The “empty” area of a page	white space
9	Someone who can give you a job	prospective employer
10	Be noticeable due to uniqueness	stand out
11	Improve or increase	boost
12	Highlight or draw attention to	showcase

Exercise 1C. Antonyms: 1 showcase — **b** (hide); 2 extensive — **a** (small, limited); 3 boost — **d** (hinder, decrease); 4 take off — **c** (add).

Exercise 1D.

1. Should I **take off** my contact details? I don't think I need to include them.
2. We have conducted **extensive** research on this topic.
3. I **boosted** sales by over 50% within two months.
4. If you want to **showcase** your work, you will need a portfolio.

Exercise 2. About my résumé:

1. I created the first version in Canva in June 2026 and updated it in October 2026 after the analysis in class.
2. The first version was a Canva template with my own design: two columns, a round photo and company logos. The final version is a simpler one-column layout, which is easier for an ATS.

3. Yes. I kept it relevant to DevOps and networking, did not include personal details (age, marital status, hobbies), focused on achievements with numbers (700+ users), kept it to one page, used keywords from vacancies (Docker, Linux, CI/CD) and proofread it.

LESSON 6 · 07/10/2026

Achievements. Education

1. Task 1.2 — complete the résumé summaries

1. Computer science student, passionate about Operating Systems. **Knowledgeable** about Linux kernel development.
2. **Seasoned** PHP programmer with over 7 years of industry experience. **Adept** at creating dynamic web pages that don't require much upkeep. **Proficient** in Laravel.
3. Experienced mobile developer skilled at React Native and Flutter. Passionate about creating **sleek**, efficient applications that solve business problems.
4. Project Manager with over 5 years of experience in managing complex software projects and an **extensive** background in QA and business analysis. Focused on **leveraging** teamwork to deliver optimal business solutions.

2. Task 1.3 — match the action verbs

#	Sentence
1	**Boosted** backtesting speed by 200%
2	**Led** a team of 7 people using Agile methodology to create an e-commerce website
3	**Forged** positive relationships with clients and vendors, increasing the company's annual profit margin by 30%
4	**Designed** innovative design solutions to create intuitive web interfaces
5	**Ensured** successful database migrations and data security
6	**Decreased** page load speed by 40% (more precisely: page load *time*)
7	**Optimized** the app's performance by 60% using code refactoring
8	**Advised** the design team on best practices and approaches
9	**Wrote** automation scripts that made the testing process 60% more efficient
10	**Analyzed** customer feedback and market trends to come up with best technical solutions

→ *“Performed” is the extra verb in the box.*

3. My achievements by the formula

Formula: **action verb + tool or technology + result + number**.

Action verb	Tool / technology	Result	Number
Designed and built	Cisco: VLANs, inter-VLAN routing, STP, redundant uplinks	a 3-tier campus network that stays available when one link fails	700+ users
Containerise and run	Docker, Linux VPS, Nginx	the client's website in production	1 production website (Luxora, Germany)
Secured	port security, DHCP snooping, DAI, ACLs, WPA3	a protected campus network	5 security features
Performed	ISO 27001, internal and external VAPT	a prioritised remediation report	1 commercial client
Build	KPI frameworks and analytical dashboards	performance tracking of cross-department work	—

→ *I did not add numbers that I cannot prove (for example, % of faster deployment). When I measure them, I will add them to the bullets.*

4. Education section

B.Sc. in Information Systems and Technologies (educational programme: IoT Software Technologies), Taras Shevchenko National University of Kyiv, 2024 – present (expected graduation: 2028), GPA 90+/100.

Certifications: Cisco Networking Academy — CCNA: Introduction to Networks; CCNA: Switching, Routing, and Wireless Essentials; CCNA: Enterprise Networking, Security, and Automation; Cybersecurity Essentials. Google.org & Hackathon 2025 — Fundamentals of Cybersecurity for Small Organizations. Oracle — Database Foundations. In progress: Mate Academy DevOps track.

LESSON 7 · 14/10/2026

Analysis of your résumés

1. Video: Warren Buffett and Charlie Munger explain the circle of competence

- Buffett: the key is to know **the perimeter of your circle of competence** — where it begins and ends.
- Even Buffett went outside his circle: most often in retail (a department store in Baltimore) and when he decided to buy control of Berkshire Hathaway — “a dumb decision”, which worked out.
- Mrs B of the Furniture Mart knew exactly **what she knew and what she didn't** — she refused stock because she did not understand it — and that took her a long way.
- To learn where your circle is, ask **friends who know you well** for honest feedback.
- Munger: competence is **relative** — play the games where you can win.

Circle	Me
What I know and what matters for my job	Linux, Docker, Nginx, Cisco networking, network security, Python, SQL
What I don't know yet, but it matters	CI/CD pipelines, Terraform, AWS / Azure, deeper Kubernetes — this is my learning plan
What doesn't matter for my career now	for example, mobile app design or video editing

2. ATS self-check of the final résumé

The teacher's ATS checkers (Jobscan, Resume Worded, Enhancv) need an account and an upload, so I made the same check myself: I compared the text of my final résumé with the keywords of the Rangein vacancy (my closest match).

Keyword	In my résumé	Keyword	In my résumé
Linux	✓ yes	monitoring	✓ yes
Docker	✓ yes	Prometheus	✓ yes
CI/CD	✓ yes	Grafana	✓ yes
Git	✓ yes	Kubernetes	✓ yes
Bash	✓ yes	Terraform	✓ yes
Python	✓ yes	AWS	✓ yes
Nginx	✓ yes	Azure	✓ yes
DNS	✗ no	GCP	✗ no
HTTP	✗ no	Ansible	✗ no
networking	✓ yes	GitHub Actions	✗ no

Result: 15 of 20 keywords (75%). Missing: DNS, HTTP, GCP, Ansible, GitHub Actions. I did not add the missing words artificially (“keyword stuffing”): they are exactly the skills I am still learning — cloud, CI/CD tools and infrastructure as code. Other ATS rules are met: one column, standard headings, a readable font (Arial), PDF format and no images except the photo.

TO DO: Optional: upload Resume_Petro_Kravchenko.pdf to jobscan.co together with the Rangein job description and compare the score.

3. Send the résumé to the teacher

TO DO: Send Resume_Petro_Kravchenko.pdf to the teacher via Telegram.

LESSON 8 · 21/10/2026

Analysis of your résumés. Webinar “The Power of You”

1. Revise and improve the résumé

The final version is in the file “Resume_Petro_Kravchenko” (PDF and DOCX). What I changed:

What	Before	After
Job title	«DevOps Engineer & Network» (grammatically incomplete)	«Junior DevOps & Network Engineer»
Languages	missing	added: Ukrainian (native), English B1 — a required section
Font	Evolventa (decorative)	Arial, 10–11 pt body, 14 pt headings (teacher's “Fonts matter” rules)
Images	Cisco, Oracle and Docker logos	logos removed (ATS cannot read images); the photo stays
Layout	two text columns	one column with standard headings — easier for an ATS to read
Verb tenses	«Developing…», «Handling…» for current work	base form for current roles (Develop, Build), past tense for finished ones (Designed, Performed)
Profile	7 lines; «Certified across 5 Cisco courses» while only 4 Cisco courses are listed	4 sentences (who I am, what I offer, what I bring); no unverifiable count
Education	«2024–present | GPA 90+»	full degree name, expected graduation 2028, GPA 90+/100
Contacts	LinkedIn only as a hidden hyperlink	full LinkedIn URL in text, readable by people and ATS

2. Video: “How to Write a Cover Letter” (Speak Confident English)

1. When do you need a cover letter? Always when the job description asks for one; never when it says not to send one. If it says nothing, a cover letter is a good idea when someone referred you to the position, when something in your résumé needs an explanation (a gap in your work history or a background that does not match perfectly), or when you are changing your career field.

2. Why might a cover letter be useful to you? A well-written cover letter helps you stand out from the competition. You can mention a referral, explain a gap or a career change, and say why you are the right person for the job.

How is it different from a résumé? A résumé is **objective**: only facts about your education, experience, responsibilities and achievements, written in bullet points without “I” or “you”. A cover letter is **subjective**: it explains why you are the right fit and how your skills will help the company. It is personal and conversational, written in paragraphs, and it tells one or two stories instead of repeating the résumé.

3. The four tips for writing a perfect cover letter:

1. **Write it like a professional business letter.** Find the name of the person and avoid “To whom it may concern”; if you cannot find a name, write “Dear Hiring Manager”.
2. **Make it conversational.** Use “I” and “you”: the résumé line “Led a team of 14…” becomes “I led a team of 14…” with more detail.
3. **Include keywords** from the job description and from what you read about the company.

4. **Use three or four paragraphs**: an introduction (how you found the position and what excites you), one or two paragraphs about your value with one story, and a closing with a call to action. Keep it to one page and do not repeat your résumé.

→ My own cover letter, written with these four tips, is in the file "Cover_letter_Petro_Kravchenko" (for the Rangein vacancy).

3. Useful tips: my soft skills and unique qualities

Following the teacher's example (*skill: where I show it*) and replacing template words with stronger ones:

Template word	Stronger word	Where I show it
responsible	accountable by default, end-to-end ownership	I build, deploy and support the Luxora website myself.
stress-resistant	composed under pressure	Troubleshooting a production website when it must work come rain or shine.
attentive to details	meticulous	Full physical and logical documentation and an IP plan for the campus network.
communicative	bridge-building	Explaining technical decisions to the client and reporting to several departments.
fast learner	learning-agile	Cisco, Oracle and Mate Academy courses on top of full-time study.

Unique qualities: *systems-minded* — I see the whole chain from the network cable to the Docker container; *security-first* — I think about protection while I design, not after; *evidence-led* — I trust monitoring data more than guesses.

LESSON 9 · 28/10/2026

Cover letter. Feedback. The benefits of using LinkedIn

1. Learn new words

→ *Learnt — see my example sentences in Appendix A (28/10).*

2. Submit the final version of the résumé

→ *Done: Resume_Petro_Kravchenko.pdf (see the list of changes in the lesson of 21/10).*

3. Feedback on Module 1

TO DO: Fill in the Google Form (forms.gle/rVzhnjAjrj8dtcvp9) with your own opinion.

4. A video of my pitch

The script is in the file “Pitch_script_Petro_Kravchenko” (about 80 seconds).

TO DO: Record the video yourself (camera at eye level, plain background, good light, speak slowly) and send it to the teacher.

5. Teamwork: Benefits of using LinkedIn — Personal Branding, Career Growth & Development

Group: Denys, Nastia B., Yehor, Petro. My notes for our part of the presentation:

Why LinkedIn? LinkedIn has more than **1 billion members in more than 200 countries and territories** (LinkedIn, about.linkedin.com). Its mission is to “connect the world's professionals to make them more productive and successful”. For a student, it is the easiest way to get the ball rolling with a career.

Personal branding. Your personal brand is what people think of you as a professional. On LinkedIn you build it with a **professional photo**, a clear **headline** (for example, “Junior DevOps & Network Engineer | Docker · Linux · Cisco”), an **About** section that works like the summary in a résumé, and a **Featured** section with your best projects. When colleagues **endorse** your skills and write **recommendations**, recruiters see that other people trust you.

Career growth. Recruiters search LinkedIn every day, so a complete profile works for you come rain or shine. You can turn on **Open to Work**, set **job alerts**, follow companies you like and contact alumni of your university. A network of real professionals often brings opportunities that are never advertised.

Development. LinkedIn is also a place to learn: you can follow experts, read posts and articles about your field, join groups and events, and take courses on **LinkedIn Learning**. Adding new certificates to the **Licenses & certifications** section shows that you are eager to learn.

My plan. I will update my headline and About section with the text of my new résumé, add the campus network and Luxora projects to Featured, list my Cisco and Oracle certificates, and ask my teammates to endorse my Docker and networking skills.

Words from 28/10 used in the talk: get the ball rolling, endorse, come rain or shine, eager to learn.

6. Grammar exercise: “The Intern — The Video Résumé” (listeninenglish.com)

Questions:

Question	Answer
What does Ben say about himself?	He is retired; he has lots of free time; he has travelled around the world. (Not true: his wife died 3.5 years ago, not a few months ago; he is not unhappy.)
Where does he go in the morning?	To Starbucks.
What has Ben tried to keep busy?	Golf, yoga, cooking (“learned to cook”), language classes (Mandarin).
Why does Ben go to San Diego?	To see his family.
How does Ben feel about his family?	They are great; he depends on them too much.
What did Ben see in the market?	A flyer for an intern job.
What are the requirements for the job?	Over 65; an interest in e-commerce; hard-working (also: organisational skills).
What type of company is it?	It sells clothing online.
How can he apply for the job?	He must submit a video.
Why does he want the job?	He wants to be needed, to keep busy and to have new challenges.
What will be most difficult for Ben?	Dealing with technology.

Vocabulary review: 1 playing hooky from; 2 come rain or shine; 3 with a roll-up-your-sleeves attitude; 4 hit him like a ton of bricks; 5 out of the corner of his eye.

Grammar (prepositions): some time **on** my hands; gone **for** three and a half years; travelled **—** the globe; the key **to** this whole deal; I'm **at** my Starbucks **by** 7:15; looking **for** senior interns; sell clothes **on** the Internet; upload your video **to** YouTube; I'll get **—** there; good **in** a crisis; right **—** here **in** Brooklyn; I've lived **—** here; live **in** Brooklyn; help **with** that.

Sentence building (present time frame):

1. Ben is retired, and his wife died three and a half years ago.
2. At first, he enjoyed being retired.
3. He goes to Starbucks every day at 7:15, come rain or shine.
4. Ben has taken up many hobbies to keep busy.
5. These days, he only travels to San Diego to visit his son and his family.
6. Ben feels that there is a hole in his life that he needs to fill.
7. Ben sees a flyer for an Internet company that is advertising for senior interns.
8. The job is for a company that sells clothing online.
9. Ben has to upload a video cover letter to YouTube.
10. Ben thinks that the job is a good idea because he wants more excitement in his life.
11. Ben says that he is eager to learn.
12. Ben thinks that he might not be hip enough to live in Brooklyn.

Discussion. *Six things Ben did after his wife died:* he travelled the globe, went to Starbucks every morning, played golf, tried yoga, learned to cook and took classes in Mandarin (he also read books, watched movies and bought plants). *Would I hire Ben?* Yes, for a role with people: his strengths are experience, loyalty, being trustworthy and good in a crisis; his weakness is technology, but he is eager to learn. *“I still have music in me”* means that he still has energy and something valuable to give, so he is not ready to stop working. *Video résumé:* it shows personality

and communication skills, but it takes more time to watch than a paper résumé, an ATS cannot scan it, and it may lead to bias based on appearance.

7. Test: Cover Letter Vocabulary 2 (businessenglishsite.com)

#	Answer	#	Answer
1	previous	6	course
2	instilled	7	a valuable
3	fluent	8	earliest
4	understanding	9	from the
5	verbal	10	promoting

8. Extra: my cover letter

→ Written for the Rangein Junior DevOps Engineer vacancy — see the file "Cover_letter_Petro_Kravchenko".

Appendix A — Vocabulary bank with my examples

Lesson of 16/09

Word / phrase	Meaning	My example
to sell yourself short	to underestimate your skills	Don't sell yourself short: a student project for 700 users is real experience.
top-notch	excellent, of the highest quality	Our university has a top-notch Cisco lab.
to nail a job interview	to succeed in a job interview	I practise my pitch every day because I want to nail my next job interview.
to nourish	to feed, to support the growth of	Good feedback nourishes a young specialist's motivation.
a joint project	a project done together	The campus network was a joint project of our study group.
a hackathon	a short event where teams build a product	I received a cybersecurity certificate through a Google.org hackathon in 2025.
to increase	to become or make bigger	Caching can increase the speed of a website.
to feel in one's element	to feel comfortable and confident	I feel in my element when I configure a Linux server.
to stand out from the crowd	to be noticeably different or better	Real projects help a junior engineer stand out from the crowd.
to think on one's feet	to react quickly in an unexpected situation	When the website went down, I had to think on my feet.

Lesson of 23/09

Word / phrase	Meaning	My example
underlying strengths	basic strengths behind your skills	My underlying strengths are logic and attention to detail.
a skills toolkit	a set of skills	Docker and Git are an important part of my skills toolkit.
to have a knack for	to have a natural ability	I have a knack for finding the cause of network problems.
a seasoned specialist	an experienced professional	I would like to learn from seasoned specialists in a DevOps team.

Lesson of 26/09

Word / phrase	Meaning	My example
concise	brief, short and clear	A résumé should be concise — one page is enough for a student.
to thrive	to grow and be successful	I thrive in teams where people share knowledge.
a hands-on role	a job with direct practical work	I am looking for a hands-on role where I can work with real servers.
to wear multiple hats	to have several roles at the same time	At Luxora I wear multiple hats: developer, DevOps engineer and support.
vague	not clear or specific	“Helped with IT tasks” is too vague for a résumé.

Lesson of 30/09

Word / phrase	Meaning	My example
teething problems	temporary problems at the start of something new	The new deployment had some teething problems, but we fixed them in a day.

Word / phrase	Meaning	My example
business acumen	good understanding of business	Business acumen helps an engineer understand why uptime matters to the client.
to take initiative	to act without being told	I took initiative and wrote documentation for the whole network.
to leverage keywords	to use keywords to get the best result	I leverage keywords from the job description, such as Docker and CI/CD.

Lesson of 07/10

Word / phrase	Meaning	My example
in a nutshell	briefly	In a nutshell, I build and support infrastructure that is fast and secure.

Lesson of 21/10

Word / phrase	Meaning	My example
seasoned	experienced	She is a seasoned network engineer with ten years in telecom.
to leverage keywords	to use them to achieve a maximum result	An ATS ranks higher the résumés that leverage the right keywords.
to forge positive relationships	to build strong, friendly relationships	Regular updates help me forge positive relationships with clients.
a sleek app	a modern, stylish and simple application	The client wanted a sleek app that loads fast on mobile phones.
adept at something	very skilled at something	I am adept at troubleshooting Linux servers.

Lesson of 28/10

Word / phrase	Meaning	My example
to get the ball rolling	to start an activity or process	To get the ball rolling, I updated my LinkedIn headline.
relentless	continuing without stopping	Technology changes at a relentless pace, so engineers never stop learning.
novelty	the quality of being new	The novelty of remote work wears off, but the flexibility stays.
come rain or shine	whatever happens	Come rain or shine, the production website must stay online.
to endorse	to publicly support or recommend	My teammates endorsed my Docker and Linux skills on LinkedIn.
a roll-up-your-sleeves attitude	willingness to work hard	Employers value a roll-up-your-sleeves attitude in junior engineers.
tremendous	very good; very great	Mentoring can make a tremendous difference to a junior.
eager to learn	wanting to learn	I am eager to learn Terraform and cloud services.

Pronunciation (Cambridge Dictionary)

Word	IPA	Word	IPA
faculty	/ˈfæk.əl.ti/	**initiative**	/ɪˈnɪʃ.ə.tɪv/
Python	/ˈpaɪ.θən/	**accuracy**	/ˈæk.jə.rə.si/
parliament	/ˈpɑː.lə.mənt/	**organised**	/ˈɔː.gən.aɪzd/ (BrE), /ˈɔːr.gən.aɪzd/ (AmE)
architecture	/ˈɑː.kɪ.tek.tʃə/	**creative**	/kriˈeɪ.tɪv/

Word	IPA	Word	IPA
event	/ɪˈvent/	**successful**	/səkˈses.fəl/
accomplishment	/əˈkʌm.plɪʃ.mənt/		

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